

Code of Conduct

Our Commitment

Acme Corp is committed to maintaining the highest standards of ethical conduct and integrity. This Code of Conduct applies to all employees, contractors, directors, and anyone representing Acme Corp.

Core Principles

1. Legal Compliance

All employees must comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and company policies. Ignorance of the law is not an excuse for non-compliance.

2. Ethical Behavior

We act with honesty and integrity in all business dealings. We do not engage in bribery, corruption, or unethical business practices.

3. Confidentiality

Employees must protect company confidential information and intellectual property. Confidential information includes:

- Trade secrets and business strategies
- Customer and client data
- Financial information
- Employee personal information
- Unpublished business plans

Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized parties, even after employment ends.

4. Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with company interests. Report any potential conflicts to your manager or HR.

Examples of conflicts of interest:

- Owning a significant stake in a competitor or supplier
- Hiring or supervising a family member
- Accepting gifts or favors from vendors or clients
- Using company resources for personal business

5. Anti-Bribery and Corruption

Acme Corp strictly prohibits bribery, kickbacks, and improper payments. Employees may not offer or accept anything of value to influence business decisions.

6. Fair Competition

We compete fairly and ethically. Do not engage in price fixing, market allocation, or other anti-competitive practices.

7. Workplace Conduct

All employees deserve a respectful, professional workplace. Prohibited behaviors include:

- Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation
- Violence or threats of violence
- Possession of weapons on company premises
- Substance abuse or being under the influence at work

8. Company Resources

Company resources (equipment, software, facilities) are for business use. Incidental personal use is acceptable but must be reasonable and not interfere with work.

9. External Communications

Only authorized spokespersons may communicate with the media, analysts, or regulators. Direct all inquiries to the Communications department.

10. Reporting Violations

If you witness or suspect a violation:

1. Report to your manager.
2. Contact HR at hr@acmecorp.com.
3. Use the anonymous Ethics Hotline: 1-800-555-0199.

Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith is strictly prohibited.

Disciplinary Action

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in:

- Verbal or written warning
- Performance improvement plan
- Suspension with or without pay
- Termination of employment
- Legal action, if applicable

Acknowledgment

All employees must acknowledge this Code of Conduct annually.

Document Version 3.1 — Last Updated January 2026